

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of travel vaccines to children and young people (Junior Travel Vaccines)

**Hepatitis A, Hepatitis A and B, Typhoid, Meningococcal ACWY, Rabies,
Japanese Encephalitis and Cholera**

Guideline Summary: pre-travel assessment in children and young people

- Every child travelling should have a pre-travel risk assessment covering destination, duration, season, style of travel, rural or urban itinerary, planned activities, animal contact, access to medical care, and any underlying health conditions.
- Check and complete the routine UK childhood immunisation schedule first. Many travel-related infections, including diphtheria, tetanus, polio, measles and meningococcal disease, are covered by routine vaccines, and catch-up is a priority before travel-specific vaccines are considered.
- Vaccine choice and dose in children are age-dependent. Several travel vaccines have paediatric presentations with a lower antigen content or a different schedule, and some have a minimum age below which they are not licensed or not immunogenic.
- Allow adequate time before departure for courses to be completed. Where time is short, accelerated schedules may be available for some vaccines but must be checked against the SPC and current national guidance.
- Malaria chemoprophylaxis, insect bite avoidance, food and water hygiene, road traffic safety and rabies avoidance advice are essential parts of the consultation and are not replaced by vaccination.
- Country-specific recommendations change. TravelHealthPro (NaTHNaC) must be checked at the time of each consultation.

Live vaccines and immunosuppression

- Children who are significantly immunosuppressed, including those on high-dose corticosteroids or biologic therapy, and children with asplenia or complement disorders, require specialist advice and are excluded from this PGD.
- Where a live vaccine is indicated and the child has received another live vaccine within the previous 4 weeks, seek advice on timing.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of

Junior Travel Vaccines

for the prevention of travel-related infection in children and young people

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must have completed immunisation training in line with the National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training • All users must be competent in the recognition and management of anaphylaxis, and in vaccine handling and cold chain management • All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005 • All users must be familiar with Gillick competence and the assessment of consent in children and young people, and with the involvement of a person with parental responsibility

Clinical condition or situation to which this PGD applies

PGD Indication	Active immunisation of children and young people aged 12 months to 17 years inclusive against travel-related infection, in accordance with Immunisation Against Infectious Disease (the Green Book) and current NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro country-specific recommendations. Each vaccine has its own minimum age, dose and schedule as set out in the schedule of vaccines table below; the vaccine-specific minimum age always takes precedence over the general lower limit of this PGD.
Inclusion criteria	• Children and young people aged 12 months to 17 years inclusive, who meet the minimum age for the specific vaccine being administered as set out in the schedule of vaccines table. • Travelling to, or residing in, an area where the vaccine is recommended by NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro, or otherwise at occupational or lifestyle risk as described in the relevant Green Book chapter. • Valid informed consent obtained from a person with parental responsibility, or from the young person where they are assessed

	as Gillick competent. • A person with parental responsibility, or a suitable adult authorised by them, is present for the vaccination of a child under 16 years. • Routine UK childhood immunisations are up to date, or a catch-up plan has been discussed and the GP informed.
Exclusion criteria	• Aged under 12 months, or below the licensed minimum age for the specific vaccine. • Aged 18 years and over. Use the adult travel health PGDs. • Confirmed anaphylactic reaction to a previous dose of the same vaccine, or to any component of the vaccine, including any excipient or residue listed in the SPC. • Acute severe febrile illness (a minor infection without fever is not a contraindication). • Valid informed consent not obtained, or no person with parental responsibility available to consent for a child under 16 who is not Gillick competent. • Significant immunosuppression, including high-dose corticosteroids, biologic or other immunosuppressive therapy, current or recent chemotherapy, asplenia or hyposplenism, or complement deficiency. Refer for specialist advice. • Known or suspected pregnancy in a young person. • Bleeding disorder where intramuscular injection has not been assessed as safe by a clinician familiar with the individual's bleeding risk. • Post-exposure treatment of any kind, including post-exposure rabies management following an animal bite, scratch or lick to broken skin. This requires urgent medical assessment and is outside this PGD. • Complex itinerary, incomplete or unreliable immunisation history that cannot be resolved, or any clinical uncertainty. Refer to the GP or a specialist travel health service.
Cautions including any relevant action to be taken	• Facilities and trained staff for the management of anaphylaxis must be available, with immediate access to adrenaline (epinephrine) 1 in 1,000 injection and a telephone. • Syncope (fainting) is common in older children and adolescents and may occur before or after injection. Vaccinate seated and observe. • Where several vaccines are required, they may be given at the same visit at separate sites, preferably in different limbs, or at least 2.5 cm apart if in the same limb. Record the site of each. • Egg allergy: check the SPC of the specific product. Most travel vaccines in this PGD are not egg-derived, but rabies vaccine presentations differ and must be checked. • Neomycin, polymyxin, streptomycin, latex and thiomersal sensitivities must be checked against the specific product SPC before administration. • Where the child has a chronic condition, is under specialist care, or the itinerary includes prolonged rural travel, remote areas or high-altitude destinations, discuss with or refer to the GP. • Advise that vaccination does not remove the need for bite avoidance, food and water precautions or malaria chemoprophylaxis where indicated.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative options and how these can be accessed, including the GP practice and specialist travel health clinics, and on the risks

	associated with travelling unvaccinated. Provide written risk-avoidance advice appropriate to the destination. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate. Where post-exposure treatment or urgent assessment is required, arrange this the same day and do not delay.
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Schedule of vaccines covered by this PGD

The minimum age, dose and schedule below are taken from the current SPC for each product and the relevant Green Book chapter. Always confirm against the current SPC before administration, as presentations and licensed ages change.

Vaccine	Minimum age	Dose and route	Schedule and booster
Hepatitis A (paediatric): Havrix® Junior Monodose, Avaxim® Junior	12 months	0.5 ml intramuscular	Single dose gives protection from approximately 2 weeks. A second dose 6 to 12 months after the first (Havrix® Junior) or 6 to 36 months after the first (Avaxim® Junior) gives long-term protection.
Hepatitis A and B combined (paediatric): Twinrix® Paediatric	12 months	0.5 ml intramuscular	Three doses at 0, 1 and 6 months. An accelerated schedule may be used where travel is imminent, in accordance with the SPC.
Hepatitis A and B combined: Ambirix®	12 months	1.0 ml intramuscular	Two doses, the second 6 to 12 months after the first. Only suitable where there is a low risk of hepatitis B during the course.
Hepatitis B (paediatric): Engerix B® Paediatric, HBvaxPRO® Paediatric	From birth	0.5 ml intramuscular	Three doses at 0, 1 and 6 months, or an accelerated schedule in accordance with the SPC and Green Book Chapter 18.
Typhoid (Vi polysaccharide): Typhim Vi®, Typherix®	2 years	0.5 ml intramuscular	Single dose at least 2 weeks before travel. Booster every 3 years where exposure continues.
Meningococcal ACWY: Nimenrix®, MenQuadfi®	Nimenrix® from 12 months under this PGD; MenQuadfi® from 12 months	0.5 ml intramuscular	Single dose at least 2 weeks before travel. Booster after 5 years where risk continues. Required for pilgrims travelling to Saudi Arabia for Hajj or Umrah.
Rabies (pre-exposure): Rabipur®, Verorab®	No minimum age (12 months under this PGD)	1.0 ml (Rabipur®) or 0.5 ml (Verorab®) intramuscular	Three doses at days 0, 7 and 21 to 28. Pre-exposure only. Any actual or suspected exposure requires urgent medical assessment and is outside this PGD.
Japanese encephalitis: Ixiaro®	2 months	0.25 ml for children aged 2 months to under 3 years; 0.5 ml for 3 years and over, intramuscular	Two doses 28 days apart. An accelerated schedule is licensed for those aged 18 and over only.
Cholera (oral): Dukoral®	2 years	Oral suspension in buffer	Children aged 2 to under 6 years: three doses at least one week apart. Children aged 6 years and over: two doses at least one week apart. Complete at least one week before travel.

Details of the medicines

Legal category	POM (all injectable vaccines listed). Dukoral® is a POM oral vaccine.
Black triangle	Check the current SPC and MHRA guidance for each product before

	administration.
Off-label use	Any administration outside the licensed age, dose or schedule stated in the SPC is off-label and is outside this PGD, except where explicitly stated in the schedule of vaccines table and supported by the Green Book. Where a vaccine is given off-label in accordance with national guidance, this must be explained as part of the consent process and documented.
Storage	Store all vaccines at +2°C to +8°C. Do not freeze. Store in the original packaging to protect from light. Vaccine exposed to conditions outside this range must be quarantined and risk assessed in accordance with UKHSA Vaccine Incident Guidance before any decision on continued use.
Route/method of administration	- Administer injectable vaccines by intramuscular injection into the deltoid muscle, or into the anterolateral thigh in younger children where deltoid muscle bulk is insufficient. - Dukoral® is given orally in the supplied buffer, with no food or drink for one hour before and after administration. - Where more than one vaccine is given at the same visit, use separate sites, preferably different limbs, and at least 2.5 cm apart if in the same limb. Record the site of each vaccine. - Inspect each vaccine visually before administration and do not use if the appearance differs from that described in the SPC. - Children with bleeding disorders may be vaccinated intramuscularly where a clinician familiar with the bleeding risk has assessed this as safe, using a fine needle (23 gauge or finer) with firm pressure applied without rubbing for at least 2 minutes.
Dose and frequency of administration	As set out in the schedule of vaccines table above, according to the specific product and the age of the child.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	The doses required to complete the schedule for the vaccines indicated by the pre-travel risk assessment, as set out in the schedule of vaccines table.
Disposal	Dispose of used syringes, needles, vials and any discharged vaccine in a UN-approved puncture-resistant sharps container in accordance with local arrangements and HTM 07-01.
Drug interactions	Vaccines listed may generally be given at the same time as other vaccines at separate sites. The immune response may be reduced in children receiving immunosuppressive treatment; such children are excluded from this PGD and require specialist advice. Dukoral® should be separated from oral typhoid vaccine and from antimalarials in accordance with the SPC. Consult the SPC of each product for a full list of interactions.
Adverse effects	Very common and common effects across these vaccines include injection site pain, redness and swelling, fever, irritability, headache, malaise, loss of appetite and gastrointestinal upset. Allergic reactions can occur including urticaria, angioedema and, rarely, anaphylaxis. Refer to the SPC and PIL of each product for the full list.
Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse reactions to the MHRA via the Yellow Card scheme at https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk . Document any adverse reaction in the child's record and inform their GP.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: - that valid informed consent was given by the individual, or by a person with parental responsibility, or that a decision was made in the individual's best interests in accordance with the Mental Capacity Act 2005 - name of individual, address, date of birth and GP with whom the individual is registered - name of immuniser - name and brand of vaccine

	• date of administration • dose, form and route of administration • quantity administered • batch number and expiry date • anatomical site of vaccination • advice given, including advice given if the individual is excluded or declines immunisation • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken • that the vaccine was administered via PGD • the destination and travel dates on which the risk assessment was based • confirmation that a person with parental responsibility consented, and their relationship to the child, or the basis of a Gillick competence assessment Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. The individual's GP should be informed. • Adults aged 18 years and over: keep records for 8 years • Children aged under 18 years: keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)
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Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Offer the marketing authorisation holder's patient information leaflet (PIL) for each vaccine administered. Provide a written record of the vaccines given, with dates, so that the course can be completed elsewhere if necessary, and destination-specific written advice on food and water hygiene, insect bite avoidance, animal avoidance and rabies risk, and malaria prevention where indicated.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Inform the parent or carer of possible side effects and their management, and advise them to seek medical advice in the event of an adverse reaction and to report it via the Yellow Card scheme. Advise clearly when any further doses are due and that the course should be completed even if travel has taken place. Advise that any animal bite, scratch or lick to broken skin abroad requires immediate wound washing and urgent medical attention regardless of rabies vaccination status, and that any fever during or after travel to a malarial area requires urgent medical assessment.

Key references

• Immunisation Against Infectious Disease (the Green Book), Chapters 17 (Hepatitis A), 18 (Hepatitis B), 20 (Japanese encephalitis), 22 (Meningococcal), 27 (Rabies), 33 (Typhoid) and 14a (Cholera) • NaTHNaC / TravelHealthPro country-specific and vaccine-specific recommendations, checked at the time of each consultation • Summary of Product Characteristics for each vaccine administered • UKHSA Vaccine Incident Guidance • National Minimum Standards and Core Curriculum for Immunisation Training • NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions • NICE MPG2 competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions • British National Formulary for Children (BNFC)
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Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates	

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature

Valid from date	Expiry date

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or vaccine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Chris Pilkington	Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health Limited (GPhC: 2046322)		30/07/2026
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Chris Pilkington	Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health Limited (GPhC: 2046322)		30/07/2026

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		30/07/2026
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		30/07/2026

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development and issue of new PGD	30th July 2026
